With the project directory and virtual environment in place, the next step is to install Django. Activate the virtual environment, and then run `pip install`:

```
RiffMates$ source venv/bin/activate
(venv) RiffMates$ python -m pip install django
```

Activate your virtual environment.

Install Django.

Django is dependent on a couple of other packages. The `pip install` command will install the dependencies. Your results will look something like this:

```
Collecting django
  Using cached Django-5.0.2-py3-none-any.whl.metadata (4.1 kB)
Collecting asgiref<4,>=3.7.0 (from django)
  Using cached asgiref-3.7.2-py3-none-any.whl.metadata (9.2 kB)
Collecting sqlparse>=0.3.1 (from django)
  Using cached sqlparse-0.4.4-py3-none-any.whl (41 kB)
Using cached Django-5.0.2-py3-none-any.whl (8.2 MB)
Using cached asgiref-3.7.2-py3-none-any.whl (24 kB)
Installing collected packages: sqlparse, asgiref, django
Successfully installed asgiref-3.7.2 django-5.0.2 sqlparse-0.4.4
```

Now that you have Django installed, the last step is actually creating your project. Run the `startproject` command:

```
(venv) RiffMates$ django-admin startproject RiffMates .
```

Create your Django project.

Virtual environment placement and Django projects

The previous steps created the RiffMates project directory manually. It was done this way so that the virtual environment directory could be in the project directory.

By default, the `django-admin startproject` command creates your project directory for you. Some coders prefer to keep their virtual environments in a central location, rather than putting them inside the project. If you prefer this organization, you can skip the project directory creation step and use `django-admin startproject RiffMates` without the period at the end, instead:

```
code$ source ~/wherever-your-RiffMates-venv-is/bin/activate
(RIFF) code$ python -m pip install django
Collecting django
  Using cached Django-5.0.2-py3-none-any.whl.metadata (4.1 kB)
Collecting asgiref<4,>=3.7.0 (from django)
  Using cached asgiref-3.7.2-py3-none-any.whl.metadata (9.2 kB)
Collecting sqlparse>=0.3.1 (from django)
  Using cached sqlparse-0.4.4-py3-none-any.whl (41 kB)
Using cached Django-5.0.2-py3-none-any.whl (8.2 MB)
Using cached asgiref-3.7.2-py3-none-any.whl (24 kB)
Installing collected packages: sqlparse, asgiref, django
Successfully installed asgiref-3.7.2 django-5.0.2 sqlparse-0.4.4
(RIFF) code$ django-admin startproject RiffMates
(RIFF) code$ ls
RiffMates/
```

startproject without the trailing period (.)